FIRST MIDTERM MOCK EXAM - SAMPLE 4

a) Read the text carefully and complete the blanks. For blanks 1 to 5, choose the right verb form. For blanks 6 to 10, choose the right connector. (3 points each) **_____/30**

The Accidental Invention of the Microwave

The microwave [1] **invented / was invented / were invented** accidentally in 1945 by a self-taught engineer named Percy Spencer, who was leading a radar project for the defense giant, Raytheon. When he was testing a new vacuum tube called a magnetron, he [2] **realized / was realized / had realized** that a chocolate bar in his pocket [3] **melt / melted / had melted** from the heat. He decided to try another experiment by placing some popcorn kernels near the magnetron, and he [4] **was watched / watched / had watched** as the kernels popped into fluffy popcorns.

At the beginning, the high price, large size, and consumer suspicion about the new technology suppressed microwave sales. The microwave [5] **was initially considered / initially considered / had initially considered** a luxury item. [6] **What's more / However / Before**, it was only used in expensive eateries that could afford one. [7] **Besides / However / Therefore**, design improvements soon made the microwave lighter and less costly [8] **because / therefore / so** it became more appealing to restaurant owners. Microwaves soon became popular in restaurants [9] **as / so / but** the machines allowed employees to quickly heat up food when it was ordered. [10] **However / After / Therefore**, there was less food waste, fresher food, and money saved.

Glossary: kernel: grano / fluffy: esponjoso / afford: pagar, solventar / appealing: atractivo / waste: desperdicio

b) Make Wh- Questions about the following extract. Underline the answers in the text. (7 points each) **_____/35**

Ray Bradbury was born in Waukegan, Illinois, outside of Chicago. However, his family relocated to Los Angeles, California when he was a teenager. He is commonly recognized as one of the most influential dystopian, science fiction, and fantasy writers of the 20th and 21st centuries. He published more than 30 books and wrote nearly 600 short stories. Also, he authored numerous screenplays and television scripts. What's more, he was nominated for an Academic Award in 1963 for his animated film, Icarus Montgolfier Wright.

1. Where……?
2. When ……?
3. What ……?
4. ……?
5. ……?

c) Express yourself: Choose <u>ONE</u> of the topics below and write a 4-sentence paragraph. Include at least two elements from each column below. **____/35**

…enjoy…	*also*
…good at…	*before*
I can…	*however*
…find it… to…	*as*

1. Wells was not the only discoverer to be despised by his contemporaries.
2. Soft skills are as important as hard skills.

EXAM SCORE:			...../100
96-100 points= 10	76-85 points= 8	66-69 points= 6	50-55 points= 4
86-95 points= 9	70-75 points= 7	56-65 points= 5	0-49 points= 2

KEY

Exercise A - 30 points

1. was invented
2. realized
3. had melted
4. watched
5. was initially considered
6. What's more
7. However
8. so
9. as
10. Therefore

Exercise B - 35 points

(Sample answers. There may be other possibilities.)

Ray Bradbury was born [1] in Waukegan, Illinois, outside of Chicago. However, [5] his family relocated to Los Angeles, California when he was a teenager. He is commonly recognized as one of the most influential dystopian, science fiction, and fantasy writers of the 20th and 21st centuries. He published [4] more than 30 books and wrote nearly 600 short stories. Also, he authored numerous screenplays and television scripts. What's more, he was nominated for an Academic Award [2] in 1963 [3] for his animated film, Icarus Montgolfier Wright.

1. Where was Ray Bradbury born?
2. When was he nominated for an Academic Award?
3. What was he nominated for?
4. How many books did he publish?
5. Who relocated to Los Angeles?

Exercise C - 35 points

Students' own answers.